

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12412566
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Huang; Ronny et al.

Lookup-table recurrent language model

Abstract

A computer-implemented method includes receiving audio data that corresponds to an utterance spoken by a user and captured by a user device. The method also includes processing the audio data to determine a candidate transcription that includes a sequence of tokens for the spoken utterance. For each token in the sequence of tokens, the method includes determining a token embedding for corresponding token, determining a n-gram token embedding for a previous sequence of n-gram tokens, and concatenating the token embedding and the n-gram token embedding to generate a concatenated output for the corresponding token. The method also includes rescoreing the candidate transcription for the spoken utterance by processing the concatenated output generated for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens.

Inventors: Huang; Ronny (Mountain View, CA), Sainath; Tara N. (Jersey City, NJ), Strohmaier; Trevor (Mountain View, CA), Kumar; Shankar (Mountain View, CA)

Applicant: Google LLC (Mountain View, CA)

Family ID: 80449228

Assignee: Google LLC (Mountain View, CA)

Appl. No.: 17/650566

Filed: February 10, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220310067 A1	Sep. 29, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63165725 20210324

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G10L15/16** (20060101); **G06F40/30** (20200101); **G06N3/04** (20230101); **G10L15/08** (20060101); **G10L15/187** (20130101); **G10L15/26** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G10L15/083** (20130101); **G06N3/04** (20130101); **G10L15/16** (20130101); **G10L15/187** (20130101); **G10L15/26** (20130101); G10L2015/088 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G10L (15/083); G10L (15/16); G10L (15/187); G10L (15/26); G10L (2015/088); G10L (15/197); G06N (3/04); G06N (3/044); G06N (3/045); G06N (3/0464); G06F (40/295); G06F (40/30); G06F (40/216); G06F (40/237); G06F (40/284); G06F (40/289)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
10176802	12/2018	Ladhak	N/A	G10L 15/16
10431210	12/2018	Huang	N/A	G06N 3/084
11256707	12/2021	Xiong	N/A	G06N 3/045
11610586	12/2022	Qiu	N/A	G10L 15/08
2017/0186432	12/2016	Aleksic et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0270100	12/2016	Audhkhasi	N/A	G06F 40/289
2018/0329897	12/2017	Kalchbrenner	N/A	G06F 40/44
2021/0232753	12/2020	He	N/A	G06F 40/216
2021/0264220	12/2020	Wei	N/A	G06N 20/10
2021/0279042	12/2020	Allamanis	N/A	G06N 3/049
2022/0253502	12/2021	Alonichau	N/A	G06F 40/30

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
3039551	12/2017	CA	G06F 17/2705
20210154849	12/2020	KR	G06N 3/044

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Ehsan Variani, David Rybach, Cyril Allauzen, Michael Riley ““Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT)” (Mar. 12, 2020)” arXiv:2003.07705v1 [eess.AS] Mar. 12, 2020, (Year: 2020) (Year: 2020). cited by examiner

Ehsan Variani, David Rybach, Cyril Allauzen, Michael Riley ““Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT)” (Mar. 12, 2020)” arXiv:2003.07705v1 [eess.AS] Mar. 12, 2020, (Year: 2020). cited by examiner

Ogawa, A., Delcroix, M., Karita, S., & Nakatani, T. (2019). Improved Deep Duel Model for Rescoring N-Best Speech Recognition List Using Backward LSTMLM and Ensemble Encoders. In Interspeech (pp. 3900-3904). (Year: 2019). cited by examiner

Ronny Huang W et al.: “Lookup-Table Recurrent Language Models for Long Tail Speech Recognition”, arxiv.org, Cornell University Library, 201 Olin Library Cornell University Ithaca, Ny 14853, Jun. 7, 2021 (Jun. 7, 2021). cited by applicant

Variani Ehsan et al.: “Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT)”, ICASSP 2020—2020 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP), IEEE, May 4, 2020 (May 4, 2020), pp. 6139-6143. cited by applicant

Ofir Press et al.: “Using the Output Embedding to Improve Language Models”, Proceedings of the 15th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: vol. 2, Short Papers, Feb. 21, 2017 (Feb. 21, 2017), pp. 157-163. cited by applicant

May 18, 2022 Written Opinion (WO) of the International Searching Authority (ISA) and International Search Report (ISR) issued in International Application No. PCT/US2022/015956. cited by applicant

Indian Office Action for the related Application No. 202327062921 dated May 6, 2025. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Shah; Paras D

Assistant Examiner: Dugda; Mulugeta Tuji

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Honigman LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This U.S. Patent Application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) to U.S. Provisional Application 63/165,725, filed on Mar. 24, 2021. The disclosure of this prior application is considered part of the disclosure of this application and is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure relates to a lookup-table recurrent language model.

BACKGROUND

(2) Automatic speech recognition (ASR) systems have increased in popularity in recent years for assistant enabled devices. Improving the recognition of words infrequently spoken is an ongoing problem for ASR systems. Words that are infrequently spoken are rarely included in acoustic training data and, therefore, are difficult for ASR systems to accurately recognize in speech. In some instances, ASR systems include language models that train on text-only data to improve

recognition of infrequently spoken words. However, these language models often include large memory and computational requirements that lead to a decrease in efficiency of ASR systems.

SUMMARY

(3) One aspect of the disclosure provides a computer-implemented method that when executed on data processing hardware causes the data processing hardware to perform operations for performing speech recognition using a lookup-table recurrent language model. The operations include receiving audio data that corresponds to an utterance spoken by a user and captured by a user device. The operations also include processing, using a speech recognizer, the audio data to determine a candidate transcription that includes a sequence of tokens for the spoken utterance. For each token in the sequence of tokens, the operations include determining a token embedding for the corresponding token using a first embedding table, determining a n-gram token embedding for a previous sequence of n-gram tokens using a second embedding table, and concatenating the token embedding and the n-gram token embedding to generate a concatenated output for the corresponding token. The operations also include rescore, using an external language model, the candidate transcription for the spoken utterance by processing the concatenated output generated for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens.

(4) Implementations of the disclosure may include one or more of the following optional features. In some implementations, the external language model includes a recurrent neural network language model. The external language model may integrate with the speech recognizer by Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT) factorizing the speech recognizer. In some examples, the speech recognizer includes a conformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder. In other examples, the speech recognizer includes a transformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder. Optionally, each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription may represent a word in the candidate transcription. Each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription may represent a wordpiece in the candidate transcription.

(5) In some implementations, each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents an n-gram, phoneme, or grapheme in the candidate transcription. In some examples, the first and second embedding tables are stored sparsely on memory hardware in communication with the data processing hardware. Determining the token embedding for the corresponding token may include retrieving the token embedding from the first embedding table via a look-up without requiring access to any graphics processing units and/or tensor processing units. Optionally, the data processing hardware may reside on the user device.

(6) Another aspect of the disclosure provides a system that includes data processing hardware and memory hardware storing instructions that when executed on the data processing hardware causes the data processing hardware to perform operations. The operations include receiving audio data that corresponds to an utterance spoken by a user and captured by a user device. The operations also include processing, using a speech recognizer, the audio data to determine a candidate transcription that includes a sequence of tokens for the spoken utterance. For each token in the sequence of tokens, the operations include determining a token embedding for the corresponding token using a first embedding table, determining a n-gram token embedding for a previous sequence of n-gram tokens using a second embedding table, and concatenating the token embedding and the n-gram token embedding to generate a concatenated output for the corresponding token. The operations also include rescore, using an external language model, the candidate transcription for the spoken utterance by processing the concatenated output generated for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens.

(7) Implementations of the disclosure may include one or more of the following optional features. In some implementations, the external language model includes a recurrent neural network language model. The external language model may integrate with the speech recognizer by Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT) factorizing the speech recognizer. In some examples, the speech

recognizer includes a conformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder. In other examples, the speech recognizer includes a transformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder. Optionally, each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription may represent a word in the candidate transcription. Each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription may represent a wordpiece in the candidate transcription

(8) In some implementations, each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents an n-gram, phoneme, or grapheme in the candidate transcription. In some examples, the first and second embedding tables are stored sparsely on memory hardware in communication with the data processing hardware. Determining the token embedding for the corresponding token may include retrieving the token embedding from the first embedding table via a look-up without requiring access to any graphics processing units and/or tensor processing units. Optionally, the data processing hardware may reside on the user device.

(9) The details of one or more implementations of the disclosure are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other aspects, features, and advantages will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is an example system for integrating a speech recognition model with a language model having an n-gram embedding lookup table.

(2) FIG. 2 is an example speech recognition model.

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic view of an example language model of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is an example arrangement of operations for a method of performing speech recognition using a lookup-table recurrent language model.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic view of an example computing device that may be used to implement the systems and methods described herein.

(6) Like reference symbols in the various drawings indicate like elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(7) Improving the recognition of rare word or sequences is an ongoing problem in speech recognition systems that misrecognize many input text utterances that appear with zero or low frequency in acoustic data. In particular, proper nouns such as street names, cities, etc. are rarely spoken (i.e., long tail content) and often not included in acoustic training data making the long tail content difficult to recognize for speech recognition systems. In some implementations, speech recognition systems integrate language models that train with text-only data that includes rarely spoken long tail content. That is, language models may be trained on a corpus of text-only data that includes long tail content that is absent in acoustic data and can bias speech recognition systems toward correctly decoding the long tail content.

(8) In order to accurately model the vast amounts of long tail content, language models need to increase the size of an embedding vocabulary. The embedding vocabulary represents an embedding identification associated with each token of a token vocabulary (i.e., words, wordpieces, n-grams, etc.) of the language model. In most instances, increasing the embedding vocabulary includes increasing the token vocabulary which requires large amounts of memory and computational resources that burden the speech recognition systems. Further, downstream tasks of the speech recognition system are also effected by an increased token vocabulary.

(9) Implementations herein are directed towards a recurrent language model that increases the embedding vocabulary while keeping the size of the token vocabulary constant. That is, the embedding vocabulary increases independently of the token vocabulary allowing for more accurate

modeling without burdening computational resources of the speech recognition system. In particular, the recurrent language model includes a first embedding table that generates a token embedding for a current token (e.g., word, wordpiece, n-gram, etc.) of a token sequence and a second embedding table that generates a sequence embedding for the previous tokens of the token sequence (e.g., n-gram sequence). Here, the token embedding provides the speech recognition system a likelihood of transcribing a particular word and the sequence embedding provides a likelihood of transcribing a particular word based on the particular sequence of previously transcribed words. Thus, the second embedding table increases the embedding vocabulary of the language model while the token vocabulary remains constant.

(10) Scaling up the embedding vocabulary of the language model with the second embedding table requires no additional operations (e.g., computational resources) of the speech recognition system because the size of the embedding vocabulary has no effect on the number of embedding lookups or operations at each output step. Therefore, the only practical constraint for the size of the embedding vocabulary is the memory capacity. In some examples, the embedding tables are accessed sparsely and are not required to be stored on graphics processing units (GPU) and/or tensor processing units (TPU). Rather, the embedding tables may be stored on computer processing units (CPU) memory, disc, or other storage that includes capacities far greater than GPU and/or TPU memory.

(11) Referring now to FIG. 1, in some implementations, an example speech recognition system **100** includes a user device **102** associated with a respective user **10**. The user device **102** may be in communication with a remote system **110** via a network **104**. The user device **102** may correspond to a computing device, such as a mobile phone, computer, wearable device, smart appliance, audio infotainment system, smart speaker, etc. and is equipped with data processing hardware **103** and memory hardware **105**. The remote system **110** may be a single computer, multiple computers, or a distributed system (e.g., a cloud environment) having scalable/elastic computing resources **112** (e.g., data processing hardware) and/or storage resources **114** (e.g., memory hardware).

(12) The user device **102** may receive streaming audio **118** captured by the one or more microphones **106** of the user device **102** that corresponds to an utterance **119** spoken by the user **10** and extract acoustic features from the streaming audio **118** to generate audio data **120** corresponding to the utterance **119**. The acoustic features may include Mel-frequency cepstral coefficients (MFCCs) or filter bank energies computed over windows of the audio data **120** corresponding to the utterance **119**. The user device **102** communicates the audio data **120** corresponding to the utterance **119** to a speech recognizer **200** (also referred to herein as automated speech recognizer (ASR) model **200**). The ASR model **200** may reside and execute on the user device **102**. In other implementations, the ASR model **200** resides and executes on the remote system **110**.

(13) With reference to FIG. 2, the ASR model **200** may provide end-to-end (E2E) speech recognition by integrating acoustic, pronunciation, and language models into a single neural network, and does not require a lexicon or a separate text normalization component. Various structures and optimization mechanisms can provide increased accuracy and reduced model training time. The ASR model **200** may include a Conformer-Transducer model architecture, which adheres to latency constraints associated with interactive applications. The ASR model **200** provides a small computational footprint and utilizes less memory requirements than conventional ASR architectures, making the ASR model architecture suitable for performing speech recognition entirely on the user device **102** (e.g., no communication with a remote system **110** is required). The ASR model **200** includes an audio encoder **201**, a label encoder **220**, and a joint network **230**. The audio encoder **201**, which is roughly analogous to an acoustic mode) (AM) in a traditional ASR system, includes a neural network having a plurality of conformer layers. For instance, the audio encoder **201** reads a sequence of d-dimensional feature vectors (e.g., acoustic frames in streaming audio **118** (FIG. 1)) $x = (x_{sub.1}, x_{sub.2}, \dots, x_{sub.T})$, where $x_{sub.t} \in \mathbb{R}_{sub.d}$, and produces at

each time step a higher-order feature representation. This higher-order feature representation is denoted as $ah.sub.1, \dots, ah.sub.T$. Optionally, the audio encoder **201** may include transformer layers in lieu of conformer layers. Similarly, the label encoder **220** may also include a neural network of transformer layers or a look-up table embedding model, which, like a language model (LM), processes the sequence of non-blank symbols output by a final Soft max layer **240** so far, $y.sub.0, \dots, y.sub.m-1$, into a dense representation $lh.sub.n$ that encodes predicted label history.

(14) Finally, the representations produced by the audio and label encoders **201**, **220** are combined by the joint network **230** using a dense layer $J.sub.u,t$. The joint network **230** then predicts $P(z.sub.u,t|x, t, y.sub.1, \dots, y.sub.u-1)$, which is a distribution over the next output symbol. Stated differently, the joint network **230** generates, at each output step (e.g., time step), a probability distribution over possible speech recognition hypotheses. Here, the “possible speech recognition hypotheses” correspond to a set of output labels (also referred to as “speech units”) each representing a grapheme (e.g., symbol/character) or a wordpiece or word in a specified natural language. For example, when the natural language is English, the set of output labels may include twenty-seven (27) symbols, e.g., one label for each of the 26-letters in the English alphabet and one label designating a space. Accordingly, the joint network **230** may output a set of values indicative of the likelihood of occurrence of each of a predetermined set of output labels. This set of values can be a vector and can indicate a probability distribution over the set of output labels. In some cases, the output labels are graphemes (e.g., individual characters, and potentially punctuation and other symbols), but the set of output labels is not so limited. For example, the set of output labels can include wordpieces and/or entire words, in addition to or instead of graphemes. The output distribution of the joint network **230** can include a posterior probability value for each of the different output labels. Thus, if there are 100 different output labels representing different graphemes or other symbols, the output $z.sub.u,t$ of the joint network **230** can include 100 different probability values, one for each output label. The probability distribution can then be used to select and assign scores to candidate orthographic elements (e.g., graphemes, wordpieces, and/or words) in a beam search process (e.g., by the Softmax layer **240**) for determining the transcription.

(15) The Softmax layer **240** may employ any technique to select the output label/symbol with the highest probability in the distribution as the next output symbol predicted by the ASR model **200** at the corresponding output step. In this manner, the ASR model **200** does not make a conditional independence assumption, rather the prediction of each symbol is conditioned not only on the acoustics but also on the sequence of labels output so far.

(16) Referring back to FIG. 1, the ASR model **200** is configured to process the audio data **120** to determine a candidate transcription **132** for the spoken utterance **119**. Here, the candidate transcription includes a sequence of tokens **133**, **133a-n** with each token **133** representing a portion of the candidate transcription **132** for the utterance **119**. That is, each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** may represent a potential word, wordpiece, n-gram, phoneme, and/or grapheme in the candidate transcription **132**. For example, the ASR model **200** generates a candidate transcription **132** of “driving directions to bourbon” for the spoken utterance **119** of “driving directions to Beaubien.” In this example, each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** for the candidate transcription **132** may represent a single word. Accordingly, the sequence of tokens **133** includes four (4) tokens **133** each representing a single word in the candidate transcription **132** (e.g., “driving directions to bourbon”). Notably, the fourth token **133d** representing the term “bourbon” is misrecognized by the ASR model **200** for the correct term “Baubien” in the spoken utterance **119**.

(17) Moreover, the ASR model **200** may generate each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** as a corresponding probability distribution over possible candidate tokens. For example, for the fourth token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133**, the ASR model **200** may generate the tokens “bourbon” and “Baubien” as corresponding possible tokens each having a corresponding probability or likelihood indicating a confidence that ASR model **200** recognized the possible token for the respective fourth token **133**. Here, the first and second candidate token are phonetically similar,

however, the ASR model may favor the first candidate token associated with the term “bourbon” over the second candidate token associated with the term “Beaubien” since “Beaubien” is a proper noun (e.g., rare word or long tail content) likely not included in the acoustic training data of the ASR model **200**. That is, because “Beaubien” was not included in the acoustic training data, or only included in a few instances of the acoustic training data, the ASR model **200** may not correctly recognize this particular term in the utterance **119**. Stated differently, the ASR model **200** may be configured to output a higher probability/likelihood score for the first candidate token (e.g., bourbon) than for the second candidate token (e.g., Beaubien). Thus, the ASR model outputs fourth token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** as “bourbon” because of the higher probability/likelihood score. While the example describes only two candidate tokens in the probability distribution over possible candidate tokens for simplicity, the number of possible candidate tokens in the probability distribution can be any number greater than two. In some examples, each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** is represented by an n-best list of possible candidate tokens **133** associated with a ranked list of the n possible candidate tokens **133** having the highest probability/likelihood scores. Each candidate token **133** may be referred to as a speech recognition hypothesis. In additional examples, each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** is represented by the possible candidate token **133** having the highest probability/likelihood score in the probability distribution over possible candidate tokens **133**.

(18) The ASR model **200** communicates the candidate transcription **132** that, includes the sequence of tokens **133** to a language model (i.e., recurrent language model) **300**. The language model **300** may reside on the memory hardware **105** of the user device **102**, or optionally, the storage resources **114** of the remote system **110** or some combination thereof. The language model **300** is configured to determine the likelihood of outputting each token **133** in the sequence of candidate tokens **133**. That is, the language model **300** rescores the candidate transcription **132** output by the ASR model **200** by determining which candidate token **133** among possible candidate tokens **133** for each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133** is most likely to correctly represent the corresponding token **133** in the candidate transcription **132** of the spoken utterance **119**. The language model **300** may assist in biasing speech recognition hypotheses output by the ASR model **200** toward rare words, such as proper nouns or long tail content, which were rarely included, or not included, in training audio data used to train the ASR model **200**. In the example above, the language model **300** may bias speech recognition by boosting the probability/likelihood score for the candidate token **133** associated with the word “Beaubien” in the probability distribution over possible candidate tokens **133** for the fourth token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133**. Here, the boosted probability/likelihood score for the candidate token **133** associated with the word “Beaubien” may now be higher than the probability/likelihood score for the candidate token “bourbon”, thereby resulting in a rescored transcription **345** to now correctly recognize the word “Beaubien” from the spoken utterance **119**.

(19) The language model **300** may include a recurrent neural network (RNN) language model. More specifically, the language model **300** may include a lookup-table language model configured to scale up the size of the RNN language model by increasing a number of rows in an embedding table, but with only a minimal increase in floating point operations. That is, the lookup-table allows embeddings to be sparsely stored on the memory hardware (e.g. CPU memory or disc) and retrieved from the table via a look up such that the size of the table adds no additional operations to each forward pass alleviating the need for storage on limited/constrained GPU/TPU memory.

(20) The language model **300** includes a first embedding table **310**, a second embedding table **320**, a concatenator **330**, and a recurrent neural network (RNN) **340**. In some examples, the language model **300** is trained on text-only data that includes rarely spoken words (i.e., long tail content) to bias candidate tokens of the ASK model **200** to correctly transcribe long tail content.

(21) The first embedding table **310** is configured to generate a token embedding **312** for a current token **133**, $t_{sub.i}$ in the sequence of tokens **133**. Here, $t_{sub.i}$ denotes the current token **133** in the

sequence of tokens **133**. The first embedding table **310** determines a respective token embedding **312** for each token **133** independent from the rest of the tokens **133** in the sequence of tokens **133**. On the other hand, the second embedding table **320** includes an n-gram embedding table that receives a previous n-gram token sequence **133**, t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1 at the current output step (e.g. time step) and generates a respective n-gram token embedding **322**. The previous n-gram token sequence (e.g., t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1) provides context information about the previously generated tokens **133** at each time step. The previous n-gram token sequence t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1 grows exponentially with n at each time step. Thus, the n-gram token embedding **322** at each output steps assists with short-range dependencies such as spelling out rare words, and thereby improves the modeling of long tail tokens (e.g., words) in subword models.

(22) At each time step, the concatenator **330** concatenates the token embedding **312** and the n-gram token embedding **322** into a concatenated output **335**. The RNN **340** receives the concatenated output **335** and ultimately rescues the candidate transcription **132** output by the ASR model **200** using the concatenated output **335** to generate the rescored transcription (e.g., final transcription) **345**. Moreover, the language model **300** may provide the rescored transcription **345** to the user device **102** via the network **104**. The user device **102** may visually display the rescored transcription **345** on a display of the user device **102** or audibly present the rescored transcription **345** by one or more speakers of the user device **102**. In other examples, the rescored transcription **345** may be a query instructing the user device **102** to perform an action.

(23) At a single output step in the example shown, the second embedding table **320** may generate the n-gram token embedding **322** to represent the entire sequence of three previous n-gram tokens (e.g., “driving directions to”) from the current token **133** (e.g., “bourbon”) represented by the respective token embedding **312** looked-up by the first embedding table **310**. Thereafter, the concatenator **330** may concatenate the n-gram token embedding **322** and the respective token embedding **312** to generate the concatenated output **335** (e.g., “driving directions to bourbon”). The RNN **340** rescues the candidate transcription **132** by processing the concatenated output **335**. For example, the RNN **340** may rescore the candidate transcription **132** (e.g., driving directions to bourbon) such that the RNN **340** boosts the likelihood/probability score of “Beaubien” to now have a higher likelihood/probability score for the fourth token **133d** than “bourbon.” The RNN **340** boosts the likelihood/probability score of “Beaubien” based, in part, on the determination that “bourbon” is not likely the correct token **133** with the current context information (e.g., previous n-gram token sequence t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1). Accordingly, the RNN **340** generates the restored transcription **345** (e.g., driving directions to Beaubien). Notably, the fourth token **133** is now correctly recognized in the rescored transcription **345** even though the fourth token **133** was misrecognized in the candidate transcription **132**.

(24) FIG. 3 illustrates a schematic view of the recurrent language model **300** of FIG. 1. The first embedding table **310** includes a plurality of token embeddings **312**, **312a-n** and the second embedding table **320** includes a plurality of n-gram token embeddings **322**, **322a-n**. The first embedding table **310** is represented by a $U \times E$ matrix where E represents embedding dimension (i.e., embedding length) and U represents the number of token embeddings **322** in the first embedding table **310**. Generally, the number of embeddings is equal to the number V of unique tokens (e.g., number of word, wordpieces, n-grams, etc.) That is, the first embedding table **310** stores a respective token embedding **312** for each possible token **133** (e.g., word, wordpiece, etc.). For instance, when the tokens **133** include wordpieces, the recurrent language model **300** may include a 4,096-wordpiece model having two LSTM layers with 512-width and the dimensionality E of the token embedding **312** may be equal to 96. The n-gram token embeddings **322** may each include a dimensionality of 2,048 when n is set to four (4). The second embedding table (e.g., n-gram embedding table) **320** may assign each previous n-gram token sequence (e.g., t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1) an embedding n-gram token embedding (e.g., embedding identifier; **322** via a modular hash as follows.

$$(25) \text{ ngram2id}(t_0, \text{.Math.}, t_{n-1}) = (\text{.Math.} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} V^i) \bmod U \forall t_i \in [0, V) \quad (1)$$

Notably, modular hashing necessitates collisions such that arbitrarily different n-gram embeddings will be hashed to the same n-gram token embedding **322**. However, collisions reduce and performance improves by increasing the number of unique tokens V .

(26) In the example shown, the first and second embedding tables **310**, **320** receive a sequence of tokens **133** for a candidate transcription **132** corresponding to a spoken utterance **119** “Hello Pam”. Notably, the candidate transcription **132** misrecognizes the correct term “Pam” with the term “pan.” Here, the first embedding table **310** receives a current token **133** in the candidate transcription **132** corresponding to a third token **133c** in the sequence of tokens **133** (e.g., t.sub.2). The first embedding table **310** determines a token embedding **312** from the plurality of token embeddings **312** for the third token **133c** independent from the rest of the sequence of tokens **133**. In this example, the first embedding table **310** determines “pan” as the third token **133c** (denoted by the black box) because “pan” may have a 0.8 likelihood/probability score while “Pam” has a 0.2 likelihood/probability score.

(27) The second embedding table **320** receives the previous n-gram token sequence **133** in the candidate transcription **132**. Here, the previous n-gram token sequence **133** includes “<s> Hello” (e.g., t.sub.0, t.sub.1) where <s> denotes a token **133** for the start of a sentence. The second embedding table **320** determines a n-gram token embedding **322** of “<s> Hello” (denoted by the black box) based on the previous n-gram token sequence **133**.

(28) The concatenator **330** concatenates the token embedding **312**, output from the first embedding table **310** for the current token “pan”, and the n-gram token embedding **322** for “<s> Hello”, and provides the concatenated output **335** (e.g., “<s> Hello pan”) to an RNN cell of the RNN **340**. Notably, the concatenated output **335** causes the RNN **340** to increase dense parameters in order to process the concatenated output **335**, however the scaling is linear rather than quadratic since the RNN output dimensionality remains fixed. The contextual information from the n-gram token embedding **322** is not only useful as an input to the RNN **340**, but is also useful at intermediate layers such that intermediate layers/cells receive context information via hidden state specific to that layer. Accordingly, the RNN **340**, may inject the concatenated output **335** to the input activations of every layer in the RNN, drawing each from an embedding table specific to that layer.

(29) Continuing with the above example, the RNN **340** rescores the candidate transcription **132** by processing the concatenated output **335**. That is, the RNN **340** may boost the probability of the term “Pam” based on the context information (e.g., previous n-gram token sequence **133**) included in the concatenated output **335**. Accordingly, the RNN **340** may adjust the likelihood/probability score of “pan” to 0.4 and the likelihood/probability score of “Pam” to 0.6. As such, the RNN generates the rescored transcription to include “Pam” as the third token **133c** and correctly recognize the spoken utterance **119**.

(30) The n-gram embedding table **320** may effectively scale up to nearly a billion parameters. The recurrent language model **300** may be trained on a 3-billion text-only sentence corpus. The language model **300** may be further preprocessed with misspelling removal against a whitelist of one million common words, and with log(n) scaling of sentence frequencies to ensure representation on the tail.

(31) The recurrent language model **300** may integrate with the end-to-end ASR model **200** by first obtaining an effective likelihood by separating out log-posterior from an internal language model score of the ASR model **200** via Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT) factorization as follows.

$$\log p(y|x) \approx \log p(y|x) - \lambda \cdot \text{sub.2} \log p \cdot \text{sub.ILM}(y) \quad (2)$$

Thereafter, the language model log-posterior score is added as follows

$$\begin{aligned}
 (32) \quad y^* &= \underset{y}{\operatorname{argmax}} [\log p(x|y) + \log p_{LM}(y)] \\
 &= \underset{y}{\operatorname{argmax}} \left[\log p(y|x) - \log p_{ILM}(y) + \log p_{LM}(y) + \log p_{LM}(y) \right] \quad (3)
 \end{aligned}$$

The RNN-T decoder (e.g., prediction and joint networks **220**, **230** (FIG. 2)) may be HAT factorized during training.

(33) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of an exemplary arrangement of operation for a method **400** of performing speech recognition using a lookup-table recurrent language model. At operation **402**, the method **400** includes receiving audio data **120** that corresponds to an utterance **119** spoken by a user **10** and captured by user device **102**. At operation **404**, the method **400** includes processing the audio data **120** to determine a candidate transcription **132** for the utterance **119** using a speech recognizer **200**. Here, the candidate transcription **132** includes a sequence of tokens **133**, **133a-n**. For each token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133**, the method **400** performs operations **406-410**. At operation **406**, the method **400** includes determining a token embedding **312** for the corresponding token **133** using a first embedding table **310**. At operation **408**, the method **400** includes determining a n-gram token embedding **322** for a previous n-gram token sequence **133**, t.sub.0, . . . , t.sub.n-1 using a second embedding table **320**. At operation **410**, the method **400** includes concatenating the token embedding **312** and the n-gram token embedding **322** to generate a concatenated output **335** for the corresponding token **133**. At operation **412**, the method **400** includes rescoring, using an external language model (e.g., RNN) **340**, the candidate transcription **132** for the spoken utterance **119** by processing the concatenated output **335** generated for each corresponding token **133** in the sequence of tokens **133**.

(34) FIG. 5 is schematic view of an example computing device **500** that may be used to implement the systems and methods described in this document. The computing device **500** is intended to represent various forms of digital computers, such as laptops, desktops, workstations, personal digital assistants, servers, blade servers, mainframes, and other appropriate computers. The components shown here, their connections and relationships, and their functions, are meant to be exemplary only, and are not meant to limit implementations of the inventions described and/or claimed in this document.

(35) The computing device **500** includes a processor **510**, memory **520**, a storage device **530**, a high-speed interface/controller **540** connecting to the memory **520** and high-speed expansion ports **550**, and a low speed interface/controller **560** connecting to a low speed bus **570** and a storage device **530**. Each of the components **510**, **520**, **530**, **540**, **550**, and **560**, are interconnected using various busses, and may be mounted on a common motherboard or in other manners as appropriate. The processor **510** can process instructions for execution within the computing device **500**, including instructions stored in the memory **520** or on the storage device **530** to display graphical information for a graphical user interface (GUI) on an external input/output device, such as display **580** coupled to high speed interface **540**. In other implementations, multiple processors and/or multiple buses may be used, as appropriate, along with multiple memories and types of memory. Also, multiple computing devices **500** may be connected, with each device providing portions of the necessary operations (e.g., as a server bank, a group of blade servers, or a multi-processor system).

(36) The memory **520** stores information non-transitorily within the computing device **500**. The memory **520** may be a computer-readable medium, a volatile memory unit(s), or non-volatile memory unit(s). The non-transitory memory **520** may be physical devices used to store programs (e.g., sequences of instructions) or data (e.g., program state information) on a temporary or permanent basis for use by the computing device **500**. Examples of non-volatile memory include, but are not limited to, flash memory and read-only memory (ROM)/programmable read-only

memory (PROM)/erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM)/electronically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM) (e.g., typically used for firmware, such as boot programs). Examples of volatile memory include, but are not limited to, random access memory (RAM), dynamic random access memory (DRAM), static random access memory (SRAM), phase change memory (PCM) as well as disks or tapes.

(37) The storage device **530** is capable of providing mass storage for the computing device **500**. In some implementations, the storage device **530** is a computer-readable medium. In various different implementations, the storage device **530** may be a floppy disk device, a hard disk device, an optical disk device. Of a tape device, a flash memory or other similar solid state memory device, or an array of devices, including devices in a storage area network or other configurations. In additional implementations, a computer program product is tangibly embodied in an information carrier. The computer program product contains instructions that, when executed, perform one or more methods, such as those described above. The information carrier is a computer- or machine-readable medium, such as the memory **520**, the storage device **530**, or memory on processor **510**.

(38) The high speed controller **540** manages bandwidth-intensive operations for the computing device **500**, while the low speed controller **560** manages lower bandwidth-intensive operations. Such allocation of duties is exemplary only. In some implementations, the high-speed controller **540** is coupled to the memory **520**, the display **580** (e.g., through a graphics processor or accelerator), and to the high-speed expansion ports **550**, which may accept various expansion cards (not shown). In some implementations, the low-speed controller **560** is coupled to the storage device **530** and a low-speed expansion port **590**. The low-speed expansion port **590**, which may include various communication ports (e.g., USB, Bluetooth, Ethernet, wireless Ethernet), may be coupled to one or more input/output devices, such as a keyboard, a pointing device, a scanner, or a networking device such as a switch or router, e.g., through a network adapter.

(39) The computing device **500** may be implemented in a number of different forms, as shown in the figure. For example, it may be implemented as a standard server **500a** or multiple times in a group of such servers **500a**, as a laptop computer **500b**, or as part of a rack server system **500c**.

(40) Various implementations of the systems and techniques described herein can be realized in digital electronic and/or optical circuitry, integrated circuitry, specially designed ASICs (application specific integrated circuits), computer hardware, firmware, software, and/or combinations thereof. These various implementations can include implementation in one or more computer programs that are executable and/or interpretable on a programmable system including at least one programmable processor, which may be special or general purpose, coupled to receive data and instructions from, and to transmit data and instructions to, a storage system, at least one input device, and at least one output device.

(41) A software application (i.e., a software resource) may refer to computer software that causes a computing device to perform a task. In some examples, a software application may be referred to as an “application,” an “app.” or a “program.” Example applications include, but are not limited to, system diagnostic applications, system management applications, system maintenance applications, word processing applications, spreadsheet applications, messaging applications, media streaming applications, social networking applications, and gaming applications.

(42) These computer programs (also known as programs, software, software applications or code) include machine instructions for a programmable processor, and can be implemented in a high-level procedural and/or object-oriented programming language, and/or in assembly/machine language. As used herein, the terms “machine-readable medium” and “computer-readable medium” refer to any computer program product, non-transitory computer readable medium, apparatus and/or device (e.g., magnetic discs, optical disks, memory, Programmable Logic Devices (PLDs)) used to provide machine instructions and/or data to a programmable processor, including a machine-readable medium that receives machine instructions as a machine-readable signal. The term “machine-readable signal” refers to any signal used to provide machine instructions and/or

data to a programmable processor.

(43) The processes and logic flows described in this specification can be performed by one or more programmable processors, also referred to as data processing hardware, executing one or more computer programs to perform functions by operating on input data and generating output. The processes and logic flows can also be performed by special purpose logic circuitry, e.g., an FPGA (field programmable gate array) or an ASIC (application specific integrated circuit). Processors suitable for the execution of a computer program include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors, and any one or more processors of any kind of digital computer. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read only memory or a random access memory or both. The essential elements of a computer are a processor for performing instructions and one or more memory devices for storing instructions and data. Generally, a computer will also include, or be operatively coupled to receive data from or transfer data to, or both, one or more mass storage devices for storing data, e.g., magnetic, magneto optical disks, or optical disks. However, a computer need not have such devices. Computer readable media suitable for storing computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile memory, media and memory devices, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, e.g., EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, e.g., internal hard disks or removable disks; magneto optical disks; and CD ROM and DVD-ROM disks. The processor and the memory can be supplemented by, or incorporated in special purpose logic circuitry.

(44) To provide for interaction with a user, one or more aspects of the disclosure can be implemented on a computer having a display device, e.g., a CRT (cathode ray tube), LCD (liquid crystal display) monitor, or touch screen for displaying information to the user and optionally a keyboard and a pointing device, e.g., a mouse or a trackball, by which the user can provide input to the computer. Other kinds of devices can be used to provide interaction with a user as well, for example, feedback provided to the user can be any form of sensory feedback, e.g., visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback; and input from the user can be received in any form, including acoustic, speech, or tactile input. In addition, a computer can interact with a user by sending documents to and receiving documents from a device that is used by the user; for example, by sending web pages to a web browser on a user's client device in response to requests received from the web browser.

(45) A number of implementations have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Accordingly, other implementations are within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method when executed on data processing hardware causes the data processing hardware to perform operations, the operations comprising: receiving audio data corresponding to an utterance spoken by a user and captured by a user device; processing, using a speech recognizer, the audio data to determine a candidate transcription for the spoken utterance, the candidate transcription comprises a sequence of tokens; for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens subsequent to an initial token in the sequence of tokens: determining, using a first embedding table, a token embedding for the corresponding token, the token embedding determined independent from each token in the sequence of tokens that precedes the corresponding token in the sequence of tokens; determining, using a second embedding table, a n-gram token embedding for a previous sequence of n-gram tokens, based on each token in the sequence of tokens that precedes the corresponding token in the sequence of tokens; and concatenating the token embedding and the n-gram token embedding to generate a concatenated output for the corresponding token; and rescoring, using an external language model, the candidate transcription for the spoken utterance by processing the concatenated output generated for each corresponding

token in the sequence of tokens.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the external language model comprises a recurrent neural network language model.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the external language model integrates with the speech recognizer by Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT) factorizing the speech recognizer.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the speech recognizer comprises a conformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the speech recognizer comprises a transformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents a word in the candidate transcription.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents a wordpiece in the candidate transcription.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents a n-gram, phoneme, or grapheme in the candidate transcription.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the first and second embedding tables are stored sparsely on memory hardware in communication with the data processing hardware.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the token embedding for the corresponding token comprises retrieving the token embedding from the first embedding table via a look-up without requiring access to any graphics processing units and/or tensor processing units.

11. The method of claim 1, wherein the data processing hardware resides on the user device.

12. A system comprising: data processing hardware; and memory hardware in communication with the data processing hardware, the memory hardware storing instructions that when executed by the data processing hardware cause the data processing hardware to perform operations comprising: receiving audio data corresponding to an utterance spoken by a user and captured by a user device; processing, using a speech recognizer, the audio data to determine a candidate transcription for the spoken utterance, the candidate transcription comprises a sequence of tokens; for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens subsequent to an initial token in the sequence of tokens: determining, using a first embedding table, a token embedding for the corresponding token, the token embedding determined independent from each token in the sequence of tokens that precedes the corresponding token in the sequence of tokens; determining, using a second embedding table, a n-gram token embedding for a previous sequence of n-gram tokens based on each token in the sequence of tokens that precedes the corresponding token in the sequence of tokens; and concatenating the token embedding and the n-gram token embedding to generate a concatenated output for the corresponding token; and rescoring, using an external language model, the candidate transcription for the spoken utterance by processing the concatenated output generated for each corresponding token in the sequence of tokens.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the external language model comprises a recurrent neural network language model.

14. The system of claim 12, wherein the external language model integrates with the speech recognizer by Hybrid Autoregressive Transducer (HAT) factorizing the speech recognizer.

15. The system of claim 12, wherein the speech recognizer comprises a conformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder.

16. The system of claim 12, wherein the speech recognizer comprises a transformer audio encoder and a recurrent neural network-transducer decoder.

17. The system of claim 12, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents a word in the candidate transcription.

18. The system of claim 12, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate transcription represents a wordpiece in the candidate transcription.

19. The system of claim 12, wherein each token in the sequence of tokens of the candidate

transcription represents a n-gram, phoneme, or grapheme in the candidate transcription.

20. The system of claim 12, wherein the first and second embedding tables are stored sparsely on memory hardware in communication with the data processing hardware.

21. The system of claim 12, wherein determining the token embedding for the corresponding token comprises retrieving the token embedding from the first embedding table via a look-up without requiring access to any graphics processing units and/or tensor processing units.

22. The system of claim 12, wherein the data processing hardware resides on the user device.
